



# Roadmap

## Getting Started In Cybersecurity

Do Things DFIRINTLY



# A message from MyDFIR.

Thank you for the support. Cybersecurity is a field that is difficult in getting started, as it should be. You no longer have to walk this journey alone. My sole mission is to help you wherever you are in the world and in your career.

**Lets get started.**

# About This Roadmap

This roadmap focuses on how to get started into cybersecurity and was created for individuals who are hoping to transition into this field. I will walk through the steps on where to begin, what to focus on, and what to do next. There are 5 pillars listed below that you will need to keep in mind to be successful in the field of cybersecurity and I will go over them, one by one.

Time

Dedication

Commitment

Purpose

Curiosity

Do Things DFIRINTLY



# 5 Pillars Of Success

## Getting Started In Cybersecurity

### Time

You will need to be patient to excel in this field as it will take a lot of time in the beginning to get started. There is a lot to learn.

Cybersecurity is a marathon and not a sprint.

### Dedication

Cybersecurity requires focus and attention.

Be ready to dedicate your time to this field, specially in a domain of interest.

### Commitment

Cybersecurity is not easy.

A commitment to really understand and learn the concepts of cybersecurity will go a long way.

### Purpose

Understand your purpose into why cybersecurity.

If it is only about money, this field may burn you out quicker than you would like.

If it is about passion and interest, strap in and get ready.

### Curiosity

Always be cat. Focus on understanding the “why”.

Curiosity will help you in cybersecurity by asking the right questions to getting answers to the “why”.

# Roadmap

Cybersecurity Journey

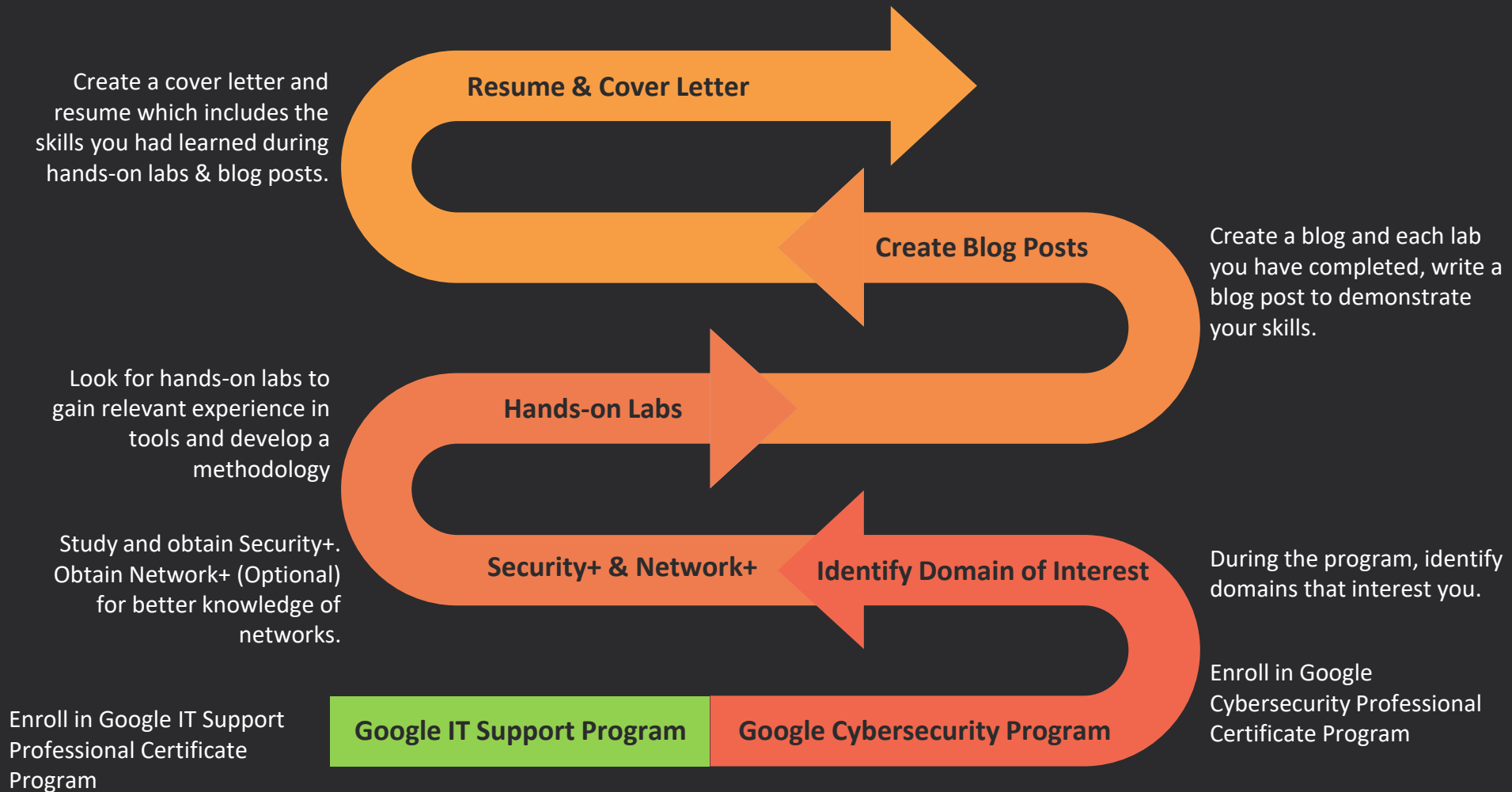
Some IT Experience



# Roadmap

Cybersecurity Journey

No IT Experience



# Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate



## Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

This is your path to a career in cybersecurity. In this certificate program, you'll learn in-demand skills that can have you job-ready in less than 6 months. No degree or experience required.

(Affiliate) Enroll Here: [Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate](#)

### Professional Certificate - 8 course series

Earn a career credential that demonstrates your expertise

4.9 ★ (3,569 reviews)

### Beginner level

No previous experience necessary

6 months at 7 hours a week

### Flexible schedule

Learn at your own pace

Identify domains that interest you the most



### Foundations of Cybersecurity

Welcome to the exciting world of cybersecurity

Module 1 • 4 hours to complete

The evolution of cybersecurity

Module 2 • 3 hours to complete

Protect against threats, risks, and vulnerabilities

Module 3 • 2 hours to complete

Cybersecurity tools and programming languages

Module 4 • 4 hours to complete



### Assets, Threats, and Vulnerabilities

Introduction to asset security

Module 1 • 5 hours to complete

Protect organizational assets

Module 2 • 7 hours to complete

Vulnerabilities in systems

Module 3 • 6 hours to complete

Threats to asset security

Module 4 • 5 hours to complete



### Play It Safe: Manage Security Risks

Security domains

Module 1 • 3 hours to complete

Security frameworks and controls

Module 2 • 4 hours to complete

Introduction to cybersecurity tools

Module 3 • 2 hours to complete

Use playbooks to respond to incidents

Module 4 • 2 hours to complete



### Sound the Alarm: Detection and Response

Introduction to detection and incident response

Module 1 • 4 hours to complete

Network monitoring and analysis

Module 2 • 5 hours to complete

Incident investigation and response

Module 3 • 6 hours to complete

Network traffic and logs using IDS and SIEM tools

Module 4 • 7 hours to complete



### Connect and Protect: Networks and Network Security

Network architecture

Module 1 • 3 hours to complete

Network operations

Module 2 • 2 hours to complete

Secure against network intrusions

Module 3 • 3 hours to complete

Security hardening

Module 4 • 4 hours to complete



### Automate Cybersecurity Tasks with Python

Introduction to Python

Module 1 • 9 hours to complete

Write effective Python code

Module 2 • 5 hours to complete

Work with strings and lists

Module 3 • 6 hours to complete

Python in practice

Module 4 • 7 hours to complete



### Tools of the Trade: Linux and SQL

Introduction to operating systems

Module 1 • 3 hours to complete

The Linux operating system

Module 2 • 4 hours to complete

Linux commands in the Bash shell

Module 3 • 9 hours to complete

Databases and SQL

Module 4 • 9 hours to complete



### Put It to Work: Prepare for Cybersecurity Jobs

Protect data and communicate incidents

Module 1 • 2 hours to complete

Escalate incidents

Module 2 • 2 hours to complete

Communicate effectively to influence stakeholders

Module 3 • 2 hours to complete

Engage with the cybersecurity community

Module 4 • 1 hour to complete

Find and apply for cybersecurity jobs

Module 5 • 6 hours to complete

# Google IT Support Professional Certificate



## Google IT Support Professional Certificate

This is your path to a career in IT. In this program, you'll learn in-demand skills that will have you job-ready in less than 6 months. No degree or experience required.

(Affiliate) Enroll Here: [Google IT Support Professional Certificate](#)

### Professional Certificate - 5 course series

Earn a career credential that demonstrates your expertise

4.8 ★ (163,915 reviews)

#### Beginner level

Recommended experience ⓘ

6 months at 10 hours a week

#### Flexible schedule

Learn at your own pace

### Technical Support Fundamentals

**Introduction to IT**  
Module 1 • 3 hours to complete

**Hardware**  
Module 2 • 4 hours to complete

**Operating System**  
Module 3 • 4 hours to complete

**Networking**  
Module 4 • 2 hours to complete

**Software**  
Module 5 • 3 hours to complete

**Troubleshooting**  
Module 6 • 2 hours to complete

### The Bits and Bytes of Computer Networking

**Introduction to Networking**  
Module 1 • 5 hours to complete

**The Network Layer**  
Module 2 • 3 hours to complete

**The Transport and Application Layers**  
Module 3 • 4 hours to complete

**Networking Services**  
Module 4 • 4 hours to complete

**Connecting to the Internet**  
Module 5 • 4 hours to complete

**Troubleshooting and the Future of Networking**  
Module 6 • 4 hours to complete

### Operating Systems and You: Becoming a Power User

**Navigating the System**  
Module 1 • 5 hours to complete

**Users and Permissions**  
Module 2 • 4 hours to complete

**Package and Software Management**  
Module 3 • 6 hours to complete

**Filesystems**  
Module 4 • 3 hours to complete

**Process Management**  
Module 5 • 5 hours to complete

**Operating Systems in Practice**  
Module 6 • 5 hours to complete

### System Administration and IT Infrastructure Services

**What is System Administration?**  
Module 1 • 3 hours to complete

**Network and Infrastructure Services**  
Module 2 • 6 hours to complete

**Software and Platform Services**  
Module 3 • 5 hours to complete

**Directory Services**  
Module 4 • 6 hours to complete

**Data Recovery & Backups**  
Module 5 • 2 hours to complete

**Final Project**  
Module 6 • 23 minutes to complete

### IT Security: Defense against the digital dark arts

**Understanding Security Threats**  
Module 1 • 4 hours to complete

**Pelcbybt (Cryptography)**  
Module 2 • 5 hours to complete

**The 3 A's of Cybersecurity: Authentication, Authorization, Accounting**  
Module 3 • 3 hours to complete

**Securing Your Networks**  
Module 4 • 4 hours to complete

**Defense in Depth**  
Module 5 • 2 hours to complete

**Creating a Company Culture for Security**  
Module 6 • 5 hours to complete

**Prepare for Jobs in IT Support**  
Module 7 • 5 hours to complete

Supplement your studies with books in IT



# CompTIA Security+

COMPTIA SECURITY+ VALIDATES CERTIFIED PROFESSIONALS HAVE THE SKILLS REQUIRED TO BE  
MORE PROACTIVE IN PREVENTING THE NEXT ATTACK

## What Skills Will You Learn?



### Attacks, Threats and Vulnerabilities

More threats, attacks and vulnerabilities from newer custom devices that must be mitigated, such as IoT and embedded devices, newer DDoS attacks and social engineering attacks based on current events



### Architecture and Design

Enterprise environments and reliance on the cloud, which is growing quickly as organizations transition to hybrid networks



### Implementation

Administering identity, access management, PKI, basic cryptography, wireless and end-to-end security



### Operations and Incident Response

Organizational security assessment and incident response procedures, such as basic threat detection, risk mitigation techniques, security controls and basic digital forensics



### Governance, Risk and Compliance

Organizational risk management and compliance with regulations, such as PCI-DSS, SOX, HIPAA, GDPR, FISMA, NIST and CCPA

Get Training Here: [CBTNuggets Security+ Training](#)

CompTIA  
**Security+**

**CompTIA  
Security+**

# CompTIA Network+



**CompTia  
Network+**  
(Optional)

COMPTIA NETWORK+ PROVES YOU HAVE THE SKILLS REQUIRED TO MANAGE TODAY'S NETWORKS

## What Skills Will You Learn?



### Networking Fundamentals

Explain basic networking concepts including network services, physical connections, topologies and architecture, and cloud connectivity



### Network Implementations

Explain routing technologies and networking devices; deploy ethernet solutions and configure wireless technologies



### Network Operations

Monitor and optimize networks to ensure business continuity



### Network Security

Explain security concepts and network attacks in order to harden networks against threats



### Network Troubleshooting

Troubleshoot common cable, connectivity and software issues related to networking

Get Training Here: [CBTNuggets Network+ Training](#)

# CompTIA A+

COMPTIA A+ VALIDATES CERTIFIED PROFESSIONALS HAVE THE SKILLS REQUIRED TO SUPPORT  
TODAY'S DIGITAL WORLD

## What Skills Will You Learn?

### Hardware

Identifying, using and connecting hardware components and devices, including the broad knowledge about different devices that is now necessary to support the remote workforce

### Networking

Explain types of networks and connections including TCP/IP, WIFI and SOHO

### Mobile Devices

Install and configure laptops and other mobile devices and support applications to ensure connectivity for end users

### Operating Systems

Install and support Windows OS including command line and client support, system configuration imaging and troubleshooting for Mac OS, Chrome OS, Android and Linux OS

### Troubleshooting

Troubleshoot real-world device and network issues quickly and efficiently

### Virtualization and Cloud Computing

Compare and contrast cloud computing concepts and set up client-side virtualization

### Software Troubleshooting

Troubleshoot PC and mobile device issues including common OS, malware and security issues

### Security

Identify and protect against security vulnerabilities for devices and their network connections

### Operational Procedures

Follow best practices for safety, environmental impacts, and communication and professionalism

Get Training Here: [CBTNuggets A+ Training](#)

CompTIA

A+

CompTia  
A+

(Optional)

# Hands-On Labs

All about gaining practical experience



## TryHackMe

Hands-on Cyber security training through real-world scenarios



## HackTheBox

Software platform to sharpen offensive and defensive security expertise.



## CyberDefenders

Training platform focused on the defensive side of cybersecurity to learn, validate, and advance CyberDefense skills.



## Blue Team Level One

A gamified platform for defenders to practice their skills in security investigations and challenges



## LetsDefend

Hands-on experience by investigating real cyber attacks inside a simulated SOC.



## OverTheWire

Learn and practice security concepts in the form of fun-filled games.



## UnderTheWire

PowerShell Training for the People



## picoCTF

The largest high school hacking competition now provides year-round cyber security education content for learners of all skill levels.

# Hands-On Labs

All about gaining practical experience



TryHackMe

Site: <https://tryhackme.com>



LetsDefend

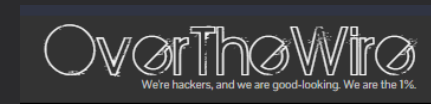
LetsDefend

Site: <https://letsdefend.io>



HackTheBox

Site: <https://www.hackthebox.com>



OverTheWire

Site: <https://overthewire.org>



CyberDefenders

Site: <https://cyberdefenders.org>



UnderTheWire

Site: <https://underthewire.tech>



Blue Team Level One

Site: <https://blueteamlabs.online>



picoCTF

Site: <https://picoctf.org>



# Creating A Blog Post

WIX

weebly

Medium



Blogger™

The main purpose of a blog post is to demonstrate both your **technical** and **written** skills. This will allow you to stand out and have something **interesting** to talk about during an interview.

# Free Blog Sites

Resources to create your FREE blog

The Wix logo is displayed in black text on a white rounded square background. The letter 'i' is stylized with a small orange dot above it.

**Wix**

Create a free website without limits.

Site: <https://www.wix.com/>



**LinkedIn**

Free to publish articles about your expertise and interest

Site: <https://www.linkedin.com/>

The Medium logo is the word 'Medium' in a black serif font, centered on a white rounded square background.

**Medium**

Create a blog for free to have a personalized home for your writing.

Site: <https://medium.com/>

The Weebly logo is the word 'weebly' in a black, lowercase, sans-serif font, centered on a white rounded square background.

**Weebly**

Suitable for all categories business and personal presentation

Site: <https://www.weebly.com/>



**Blogger**

Create a unique and beautiful blog easily.

Site: <https://www.blogger.com>

# Name

City,State ■ Phone Number ■ Email

## SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

- Add 5 to 10 qualifications on why you are qualified for this job

## AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- **Category** – List tools, see below for example
- **SIEM** – LogRhythm, Splunk/Splunk SOAR, IBM QRadar

## EDUCATION

What you majored in, diploma, degree etc.

Begin Date – End Date

School, City, State

## RELATED WORK EXPERIENCE

**Current Position**

Month Year – Present

Company

- List relevant work experience tied to the job positing

**Previous Position**

Month Year – Month Year

Company

- List relevant work experience tied to the job posting

## CERTIFICATIONS

**Certificate**

Month Obtained Year

Vendor

<Below is optional>

## WEBSITE

**Title of site**

Website URL

- List what the site is about

## TRAININGS

**Title of training**

Month Year Completion

Vendor

- List what the training was about and make sure its related to the job

# Resume Template

Download the template [here](#)



# Cover Letter Template

Download the template [here](#)

[Your Name]  
[City, State]  
[Email Address]  
[Phone Number]  
[Today's Date]

[Recipient's Name]  
[Recipient's Job Title]  
[Company Name]  
[Company Address]  
[City, State, ZIP Code]

Dear [Recipient's Name],

## First Paragraph: Introduction

Introduce yourself and state your intention to apply for the position. Show enthusiasm for the opportunity and mention where you learned about the job opening.

## Second Paragraph: Relevant Skills and Experience

Highlight your relevant skills, certifications, and experience (including lab experience) in the field of cybersecurity. Provide specific examples of projects or achievements that demonstrate your ability to secure information systems, mitigate risks, and respond to incidents.

## Third Paragraph: Company Fit and Interest

Show your knowledge of the company's initiatives and explain why you are interested in working for them. Highlight specific aspects of the company's reputation, client base, or industry focus that resonate with you. This demonstrates your genuine interest and dedication to contributing to their goals.

## Fourth Paragraph: Closing and Next Steps

Express gratitude for considering your application and reiterate your interest in the position. State that you are eager to discuss your qualifications further and provide your availability for an interview. Mention that you have attached your resume and any other relevant documents for their review. If you have a website/blog, list it here.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]

# 1-Year Timeline (12 Months)

Cybersecurity Journey

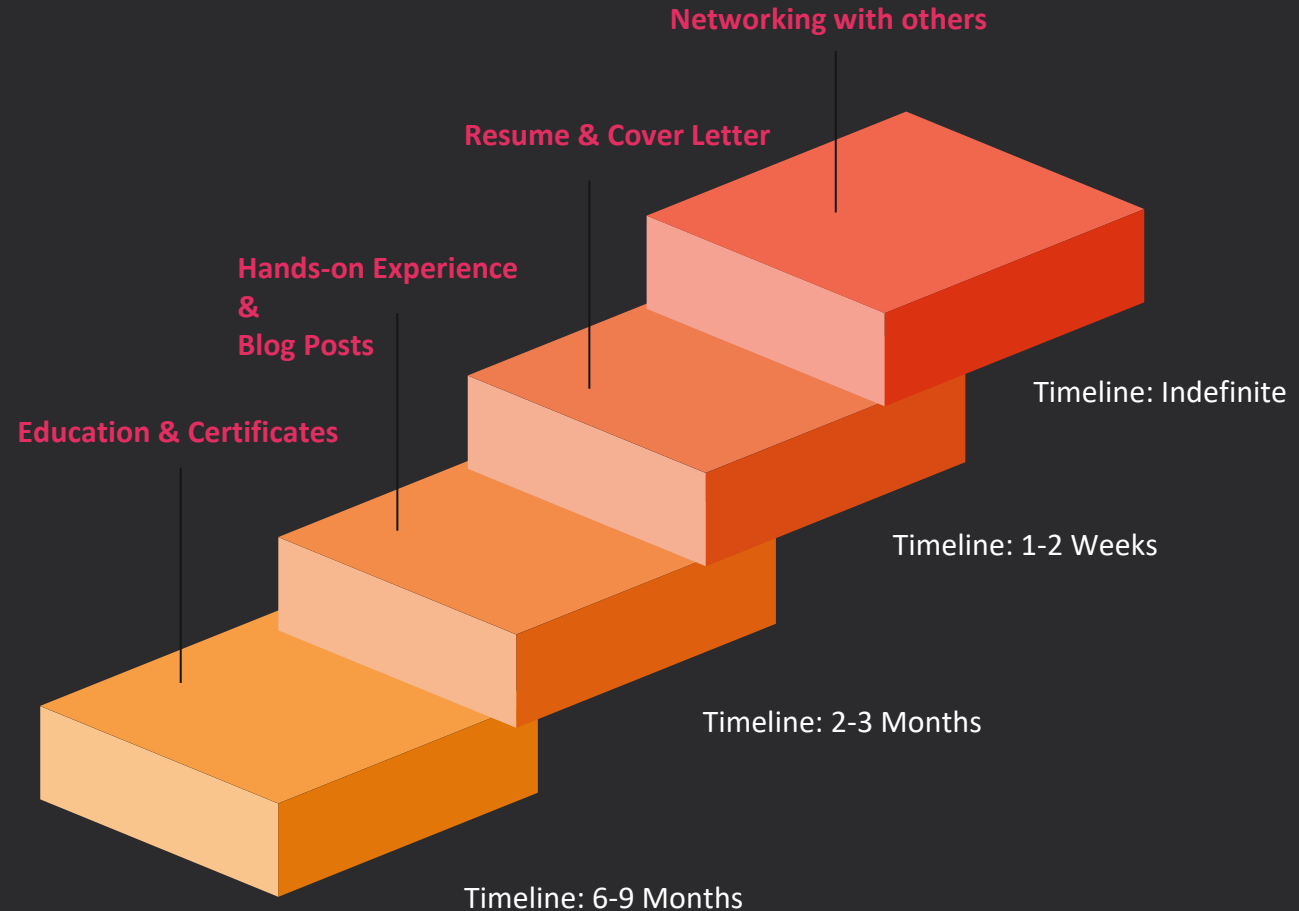
Here is an ambitious timeline to transition into cybersecurity within 1 year assuming you have some prior IT experience.

I strongly believe people who put in the work and follow the 5 pillars can achieve this.

Be true to yourself and don't try to rush the process.

"More haste, less speed"

Do Things DFIRINTLY



# 1.5-Year Timeline (18 Months)

Cybersecurity Journey

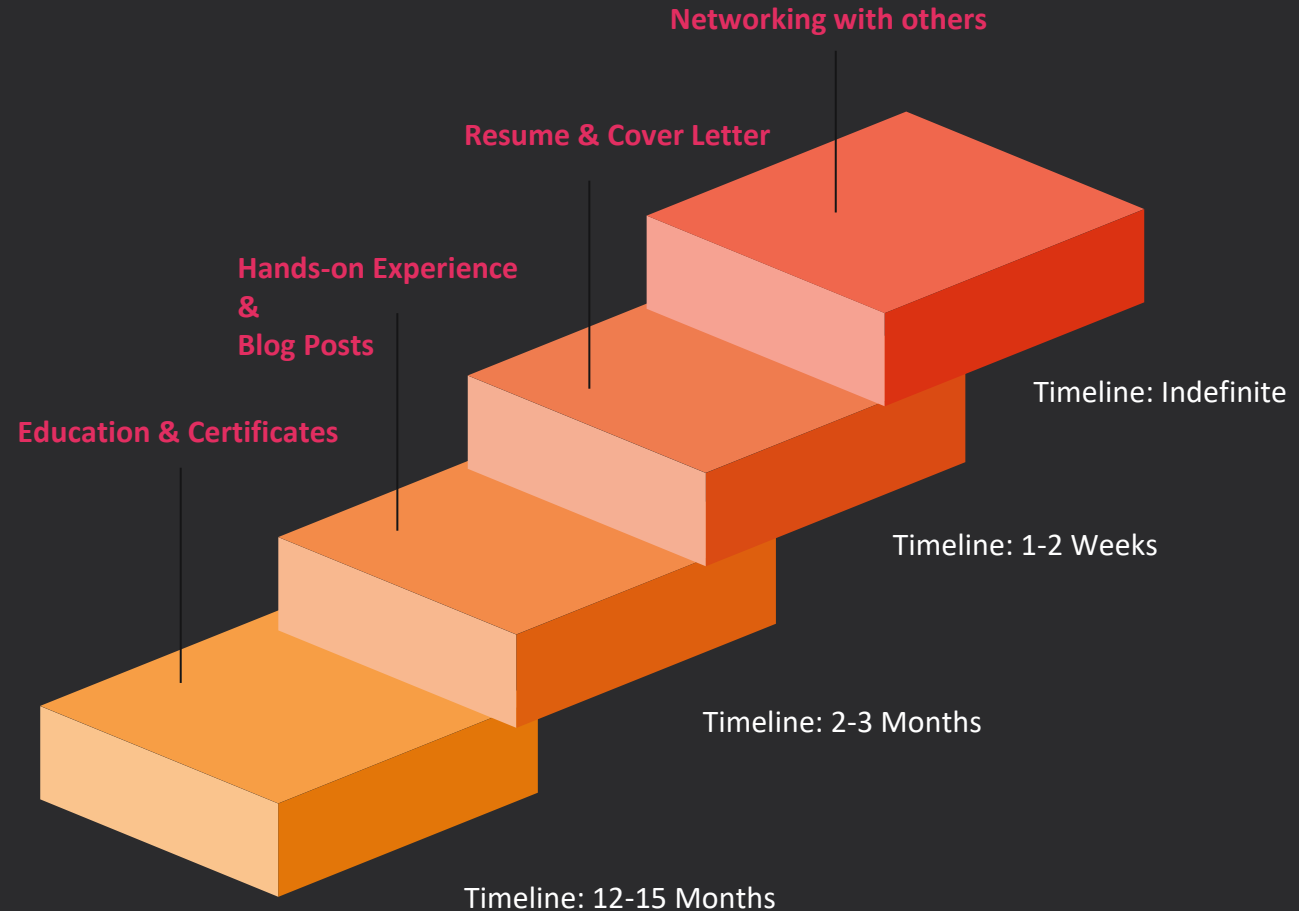
Here is an ambitious timeline to transition into cybersecurity within 1.5 years assuming you have no prior IT experience.

I strongly believe people who put in the work and follow the 5 pillars can achieve this.

Be true to yourself and don't try to rush the process.

"More haste, less speed"

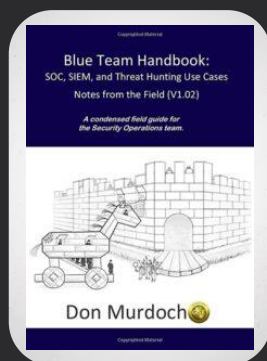
Do Things DFIRINTLY



# Recommended Books

Resources specific to Security Operations & DFIR Analysts

*These are all affiliate links*



## Blue Team Handbook: SOC, SIEM, & Threat Hunting

BTHb:SOCTH is the go to guiding book for new staff at a top 10 MSSP, integrated into University curriculum, and cited in top ten courses from a major information security training company.

Purchase



## Blue Team Handbook: Incident Response

The Blue Team Handbook is a “zero fluff” reference guide for cyber security incident responders, security engineers, and InfoSec pros alike.

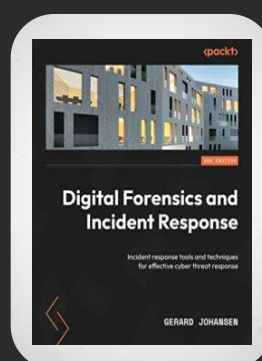
Purchase



## Applied incident Response

Incident response is critical for the active defense of any network, and incident responders need up-to-date, immediately applicable techniques with which to engage the adversary.

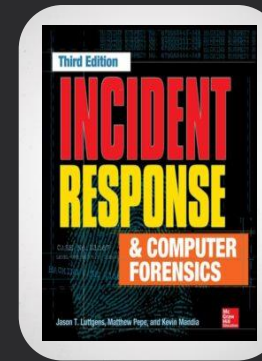
Purchase



## DFIR - Incident response tools and techniques for effective cyber threat response, 3rd Edition

An understanding of how digital forensics integrates with the overall response to cybersecurity incidents is key to securing your organization’s infrastructure from attacks.

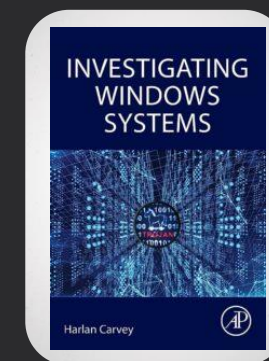
Purchase



## Incident Response & Computer Forensics, Third Edition

Thoroughly revised to cover the latest and most effective tools and techniques, Incident Response & Computer Forensics, Third Edition arms you with the information you need to get your organization out of trouble when data breaches occur.

Purchase



## Investigating Windows Systems

Unlike other books, courses and training that expect an analyst to piece together individual instructions into a cohesive investigation, Investigating Windows Systems provides a walk-through of the analysis process, with descriptions of the thought process and analysis decisions along the way.

Purchase

# Study Guides

Resources to help with certifications

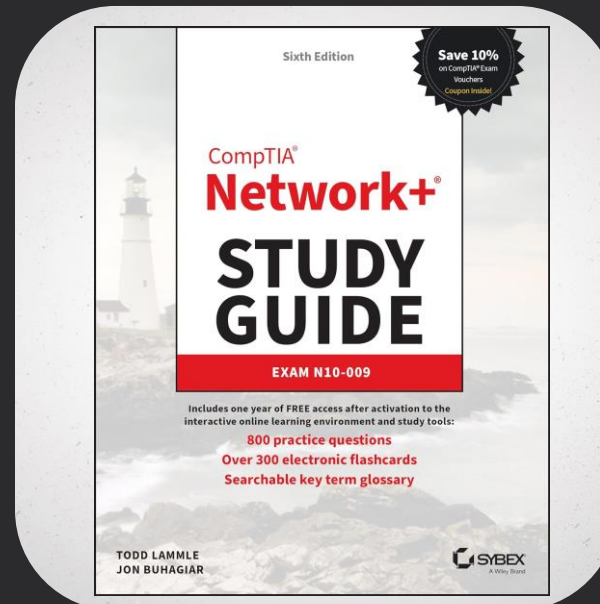
These are all affiliate links



CompTIA Security+ Study Guide: SY0-701

The Ninth Edition of the CompTIA Security+ Study Guide Exam SY0-701 efficiently and comprehensively prepares you for the SY0-701 Exam.

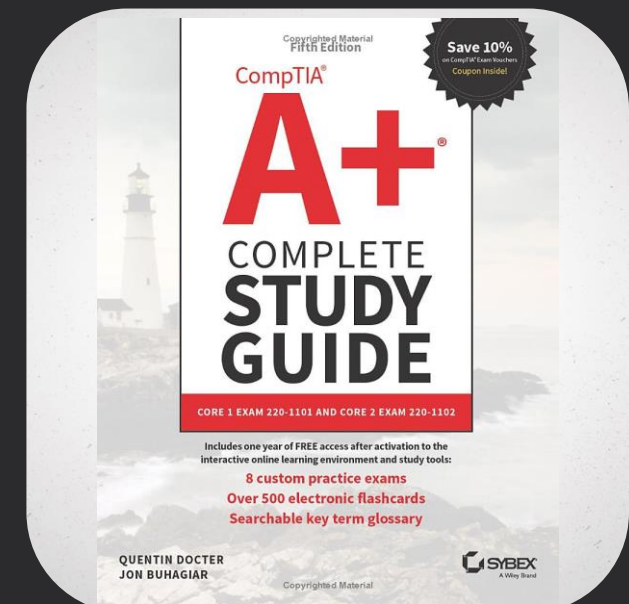
Purchase



CompTIA Network+ Study Guide: Exam N10-009

In the newly revised sixth Edition of CompTIA Network+ Study Guide Exam N10-009, bestselling author and network expert Todd Lammle and Jon Buhaigiar deliver thorough and accurate coverage of how to install, configure, and troubleshoot today's networking hardware peripherals and protocols..

Purchase



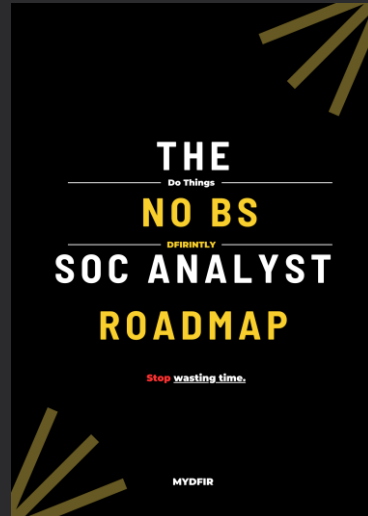
CompTIA A+ Complete Study Guide: Core 1 Exam 220-1101 and Core 2 Exam 220-1102

The Fifth Edition of the CompTIA A+ Complete Study Guide: Core 1 Exam 220-1101 and Core 2 Exam 220-1102 offers accessible and essential test preparation material for the popular A+ certification.

Purchase

# Interested in Security Operations?

Resources to help with becoming a SOC Analyst



## The NO BS SOC Analyst Roadmap

This NO BS SOC roadmap with over 100 pages designed for individuals, whether students or professionals, seeking to transition into cybersecurity with the goal of securing a position as a SOC Analyst.

[Purchase](#)



## MyDFIR SOC Analyst Course

With 8 chapters and 30+ hands-on labs tailored to security operations, I am focused on transforming you into a standout SOC analyst. Beyond tools, you'll master the investigation process and uncover hidden details.

[Learn More](#)



# Next Steps

Thank you for the support. I hope you have learned something new and are excited to get started on your journey into cybersecurity.

Sign up for **FREE** mentorship if you haven't already on my site: [MyDFIR.com](https://MyDFIR.com) and keep me updated in your progress.

**You Got This.**